

ISAAC QI

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Animal welfare; geospatial analysis; applied microeconomics.

EDUCATION

University of British Columbia

Master of Food and Resource Economics (MFRE)

Expected Aug 2026

Vancouver, BC, Canada

- One-year course-based program combining academic knowledge and practical experience to address economic challenges in climate, food, and environmental sectors.
- **Relevant Coursework:** Econometrics, Time Series Analysis, Machine Learning, Environmental Economics, Policy Analysis, Economic Analysis of Agri-Food Markets
- **GPA:** 93%

University of British Columbia

Bachelor of Science, Applied Animal Biology

May 2024

Vancouver, BC, Canada

- **Thesis:** Transitioning dairy cows to automatic milking: predictive effects of training on post-transition AMS use.

SKILLS

- **Programming & Statistical Software:** R, SAS, Python, Google Earth Engine, LaTeX
- **Econometric Methods:** Mixed Effects Models, Panel Data Analysis, Regression Analysis, Instrumental Variables, Time Series Analysis, Machine Learning
- **Data Analysis:** Geospatial Modeling (R), Network Models, Data Visualization, Dashboarding (HTML and PowerBI)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

UBC Sustainability Hub & Metro Vancouver

Sustainability Scholar

May 2026 - August 2026

Vancouver, Canada

- Identifying upstream flood attenuating natural ecosystems and downstream beneficiary communities in the Lower Fraser region through geospatial analysis.

Faculty of Land and Food Systems, UBC

Research Assistant to Dr. James Vercammen & Dr. Marina von Keyserlingk

January 2026 - Present

Vancouver, Canada

- Examining transport infrastructure and dairy cattle welfare using geospatial analysis.
- Building a spatial vulnerability framework in R to investigate how scale economies impacts animal welfare.

Animal Welfare Program, Faculty of Land and Food Systems, UBC

Research Assistant to Dr. Dan Weary & Dr. Marina von Keyserlingk

May 2023 - Present

Vancouver, Canada

- Identified novel behavioral responses in dairy cows transitioning to automated milking systems.
- Estimated mixed effects models in R analyzing individual heterogeneity and time-varying dairy cow behaviour.

AI Evaluator

Mercor Intelligence

2024 - Present

Remote

- Senior RLHF reviewer and rubric designer.
- Domain expert in agriculture, economics, and mathematics for AI model evaluation and prompt refinement.

PUBLICATIONS & CONFERENCES

C=CONFERENCE, J=JOURNAL, S=IN SUBMISSION

- [S.1] Qi, I., Heinsius, J., von Keyserlingk, M.A.G., & Weary, D.M. (in submission). Individual differences in training predict how well dairy cows adjust to automatic milking.
- [C.1] Qi, I., Heinsius, J., & Weary, D.M. (2024). Teaching Cows to Udder-stand Robots: Positive Reinforcement Training for Automatic Milking System Acclimation. *LFS Graduate Student Conference*. University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC.
- [C.2] Qi, I., Vandresen, B., & Weary, D.M. (2024). Public Perception of Genetic Engineering in Production Cattle Analyzed using YouTube Data. *UBC Multidisciplinary Undergraduate Research Conference*. University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

• Graduate Teaching Assistant <i>APBI 398 - Research Methods in Applied Biology - Dr. Dan Weary & Dr. Marina von Keyserlingk</i>	2026 - Present
• Graduate Facilitator <i>Centre for Teaching, Learning and Technology (CTLT), UBC</i> ◦ Facilitate pedagogical development workshops for graduate students on effective teaching practices.	2026 - Present
• Graduate Teaching Assistant <i>LFS 101 - Principles of Microeconomics with Applications to Land and Food Systems - Dr. Sumeet Gulati</i>	2026
• Graduate Teaching Assistant <i>DSCI 532 - Data Visualization II - UBC Master of Data Science</i>	2026
• Graduate Teaching Assistant <i>FNH 415 - Business Concepts in Food, Nutrition, and Health - Dr. Karen Taylor</i>	2025
• Research Mentor <i>APBI 398 - Research Methods in Applied Biology</i>	2024
• Undergraduate Teaching Assistant <i>APBI 314 - Animals in Society - Dr. Amelia MacRae</i>	2024

SCHOLARSHIPS & AWARDS

TOTAL FUNDING: \$32,075

• CGRS-M – NSERC Award <i>Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council of Canada</i>	2026 \$27,000 CAD
• CAES Conference Scholarship <i>Canadian Agricultural Economics Society, UBC MFRE</i>	2026 \$2,250 CAD
• UBC TSC Legacy Award <i>UBC Thunderbird Sport Clubs</i>	2026
• Academic Thunderbird Award <i>University of British Columbia</i>	2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
• MFRE Award: Land and Food Systems Professional Programs Award <i>University of British Columbia</i>	2025 \$1,000 CAD
• UBC TSC Student Leadership Award <i>UBC Thunderbird Sport Clubs</i>	2025
• Best Project: Web Design <i>Cursor.ai</i>	2025 \$300 CAD
• AI for Animals Conference Scholarship <i>AI for Animals</i>	2025 \$150 USD
• Lululemon Leadership Award <i>Lululemon</i>	2024 \$1,200 CAD
• Canadian Society of Animal Science Undergraduate Award <i>Canadian Society of Animal Science</i>	2024 \$100 CAD
• 3rd Place Poster Presentation Award <i>LFS Graduate Student Conference</i>	2024 \$75 CAD

SERVICE TO THE UNIVERSITY

• LFS Graduate Student Council <i>Faculty of Land and Food Systems, UBC</i> ◦ Treasurer & Applied Animal Biology Representative ◦ Academic Events Coordinator & MFRE Program Representative * Led the organization of the LFS Graduate Student Conference; coordinated sponsorships, logistics, and academic teams. * Secured 12 sponsors totalling \$2,000 in funding; supported 100 attendees and 50 presenters.	2025 - Present 2026 - Present 2025 - 2026
• President <i>UBC Pre-Veterinary and Animal Welfare (PAW) Club</i> ◦ Engaged in international collaborations with veterinary schools around the world. ◦ Lead animal welfare outreach activities for undergraduate students.	2023 - 2024
• Chair <i>Animal Welfare Conference</i> ◦ Directed UBC PAW's flagship Animal Welfare Conference with 11 expert speakers	June - October, 2023

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY SERVICE

- **Proctor**
Mensa Canada
 - Proctor for Mensa Canada’s standardized entrance examinations.
 - **Senior Girls Basketball Coach**
Vancouver School Board
 - Designed and executed player development programs for approximately 200 athletes over the past decade.
 - **Captain & Finance Officer**
UBC Thunderbird Sports Club Quadball
 - Rebuilt team culture, grew active roster from four remaining players to nineteen within a single season; secured #1 in universities and #1 in the west at 2026 Championships.
 - John David Nicholson Spirit Award recipient.
 - **Board Member**
Quadball Canada
 - Represented Western Canada and the university division, advised on national growth strategy.

2026 - Present

2013 - Present

2023 - 2026

2024 - 2026

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- **Facilitator Development Workshop**
UBC CTLT & CIRTL Network
 - **CIRTL SoTL Workshop**
UBC CTLT & CIRTL Network
 - **Instructional Skills Workshop**
UBC CTLT & CIRTL Network
 - **PAACO Dairy Welfare Auditing Workshop**
Modesto, CA

June, 2026

May, 2026

October, 2025

April, 2024

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: English (Native), Mandarin (Fluent)